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unusual. It has caused confusion and needless debate. Defining the rarest of rare cases is subjective. Little wonder that 20 death sentences, including one of Afzal Guru, are pending.

J.S. ACHARYA, *Hyderabad*

Agenda of Peace

We cannot have a one-point agenda while dealing with Pakistan ("Walking the Talk", May 17). To expect that Pakistan will make any worthwhile commitment to prevent its soil from being used for terrorist activities is asking for too much as its writ doesn't run everywhere on its own areas of control. However, there are a number of issues, such as the Sir Creek, Siachen, water-sharing, cultural exchange and so on, where we could have a meaningful dialogue. We should encourage people-to-people contact by relaxing visa norms as every tourist is not necessarily a terrorist too.

DBN MURTHY, *Bangalore*

No peace talks between India and Pakistan can succeed unless Pakistan dismantles terror infrastructure. Guns of terrorists, which are meant to hit India, are gradually being pointed towards the perpetrator country. Hopefully, the Pakistani establishment will realise it and pave the way for trust between the two countries.

V.K. TANGRI,

via www.indiatoday.in

Junk on the Rise

That India is the biggest fast food consumption market in the world may be good news for the industry, but not for the health of the nation ("Taste of Growth", May 17). Behind the veneer of neat and bright setting is the hidden cause of obesity and high cholesterol. Such growing popularity of fast food among the 15-20 age group should be a signal for them to treat it as an occasional delight rather

by increasing rates of depression and teenage pregnancy ("Tweeny Boppers", May 17). The sad part is that there is very little parents can do to check the contagion—neither force nor a sympathetic talk is likely to stem the wave of a heightened adult-consciousness the teens suffer from.

PUNEET MADHOK, *Bhavnagar*

Corrigendum

In the story "The Tenure Tussle" (May 17), K.P. Singh Deo's tenure as pres-



KRISHNA MURARI KISHAN

“ Nitish Kumar is in a better position to face elections because of his good administration and the strong alliance he has with the BJP. ”

A. JACOB SAHAYAM, *Thiruvananthapuram*

than a regular habit.

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, *Pune*

Teenage Tendency

The phenomenon of accelerated growth among teenagers today as they attempt to reach adulthood at dizzying speeds can have serious health consequences, evidenced

ident of the Rowing Federation of India (RFI) had been listed as 26 years. Singh Deo had, in fact, served as the RFI president for only 17 years in two terms, 1983-1991 and 1999-2008. Currently, he is an honorary RFI "Emeritus President".

EDITOR

Time for Reckoning

They are unsafe on the streets and discriminated against at work. At home, they are often worse off: reduced to slavish drudges, they are maltreated in a hundred different ways. Constantly derided, frequently bullied, sometimes assaulted and occasionally burnt to death, Indian women in any avatar remain victims. They are the primary underdogs of an exploitative society where law of the jungle persists: the more powerful thrive at the expense of the less powerful. That law, since time immemorial, has put men before women. The Government and society have traditionally adopted a patronising attitude—"it would be nice to include women in education, employment, etc". For years, women's issues have been viewed as a "social welfare" problem to be treated with appendage problems. Statistics, however, reveal that such a distorted perspective will cost the nation dear. **by**

Madhu Trehan and Sunil Sethi



EXCESSIVE CHILDBEARING IS BANE FOR INDIAN WOMEN

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